ST. MONICA MEMORIAL SCHOOLS
Beyond Learning

HEALTH AND SAFETY POLICY

Core Safety Categories

- **Physical Infrastructure:** Building stability, secure stairwells, adequate ventilation, and safe pathways.
- **Health and Hygiene:** Clean sanitation facilities, safe drinking water, and proper waste management.
- **Emergency Preparedness:** Fire evacuation procedures, disaster response strategies, and routine safety drills.
- **Food Safety:** Safe food handling, kitchen hygiene, and feeding program oversight.
- **Fire Safety:** Every building must be fitted with serviced, accessible fire extinguishers, and school must conduct regular emergency drills.
- **Sanitation:** Facilities must be gender-sensitive, adequate, and adhere to Minimum Public Health Act (CAP 242) standards.
- **Classroom Setup:** Desks must allow for orderly movement, ideally seating no more than 3 learners per desk with spacing of at least 0.6 meters (2 feet) between rows.

First Aid & Medical Emergency Policy

Key Policy Requirements

- **First Aid Boxes:** Must be clearly marked, fully stocked with bandages and antiseptic, and placed in easy-to-reach spots.
- **Trained Responders:** Designated staff must hold valid first aid training certificates and be on-site during working hours.
- **Emergency Actions:** Check the scene for safety, give basic care, and call professional medical services right away.

Emergency Response Steps

- **Assess:** Look for danger, check if the person responds, and see if they are breathing.
- **Treat:** Use basic first aid or CPR if trained. Protect yourself with gloves or masks.
- **Escalate:** Contact local emergency numbers or transport the person to the nearest clinic or hospital.

Anti-Bullying & Child Protection Policy

An anti-bullying and child protection policy is a zero-tolerance safety framework designed to stop abuse, prevent harassment, and protect student welfare. It defines unacceptable behavior, sets reporting roles, and mandates staff screening.

Core Definitions & Rules

- **Bullying Actions:** Physical hitting, verbal name-calling, social exclusion, and online cyberbullying.
- **Child Protection:** Safeguarding kids from neglect, emotional harm, physical injury, and sexual exploitation.
- **Scope:** Applies on school grounds, during digital learning, and on all school-sponsored trips.

Key Policy Requirements

- **Safe Reporting:** Clear steps for children to report issues to trusted adults or designated staff members.
- **Staff Vetting:** Mandatory background checks and police clearances for all workers.

Immediate Response: Documenting incidents, protecting victims, and involving parents while keeping records private and secure.

Student Discipline Policy

Outlines the Code of Conduct, categories of behavior infractions, and the progressive steps used to guide student behavior. Core elements typically include clear expectations, predefined corrective actions, and due process rights for appeals.

Code of Conduct and Expectations

- **Behavior Standards:** Respect for teachers and peers, safe conduct, and regular attendance.
- **Dress Code:** Neat, modest clothing without offensive graphics or foul language.
- **Prohibited Acts:** Bullying, fighting, academic dishonesty, and property damage.

Classification of Infractions

- **Minor Infractions:** Tardiness, uniform violations, or talking out of turn.
- **Major Infractions:** Repeated minor issues, gross defiance, theft, or physical violence.

Disciplinary Procedures

- **Informal Action:** Verbal warnings or time-outs managed directly by the teacher.
- **Formal Action:** Written referrals, parent contact, detention, or temporary suspension.
- **Appeal Process:** The right for students or parents to contest major disciplinary decisions before a review panel or administrator.

Child Safeguarding Policy

Core Policy Elements

- **Policy Statement:** A firm commitment to upholding the best interest principle and ensuring student welfare.

- **Definitions:** Clear distinction between safeguarding (preventing harm) and child protection (responding to abuse or neglect).
- **Code of Conduct:** Expected behavioral boundaries for teachers, staff, volunteers, and visitors regarding physical contact, communication, and digital interactions.
- **Procedures and Implementation:**
    - **Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL):** Appointment of a specific trained staff member responsible for handling disclosures, recording incidents, making external referrals.
    - **Safe Recruitment:** Mandatory background checks, reference verifications, and screening for all individuals working with students.
    - **Reporting Workflow:** Step-by-step instructions for staff on how to document concerns and escalate them promptly to management or statutory authorities.

1. Policy Statement & Scope

- **Core Commitment:** Absolute zero-tolerance framework for child abuse, neglect, and exploitation.
- **Best Interest:** Every operational decision prioritizes the child's physical, emotional, and psychological safety.
- **Scope:** Applies to all teachers, teaching assistants, administrators, kitchen staff, drivers, and external vendors.

2. Key Safeguarding Pillars for Kindergarten

- **Intimate Care & Nappy Changing**
    - **Two-Adult Rule:** Ensuring staff are within sight or hearing of another adult during changing.
    - **Privacy & Dignity:** Maintaining the child's privacy while ensuring visibility for safety monitors.
- **Touch Boundaries:** Explicit guidelines on appropriate physical contact for comforting distressed toddlers.
- **Safe Recruitment & Visit Management**
    - **Vetting:** Mandatory criminal record checks and reference verification for all hires.
    - **Supervision:** No unvetted visitor or parent is ever left unsupervised with children.

- **Identification:** Clear name badges and logged entry/exit times for all visitors.

- **Digital Safety & Photography**
    - **Device Restrictions:** Staff personal phones are strictly banned in classrooms and bathrooms.
    - **Consent:** Zero photography or filming of children without explicit, written parental consent.
    - **Storage:** Kindergarten-owned devices only for documenting milestones; photos stored securely.

3. Reporting & Escalation Workflow

- Staff Member identifies concern / sign of abuse



- Verbally inform DSL immediately



- Complete written incident log within 2 hrs



- DSL Evaluates & Contacts Authorities.

4. Key Roles & Responsibilities

Role	**Core Safeguarding Responsibility**	**Training Requirement**
Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	Handles disclosures, manages records, and contacts child protection authorities.	Advanced safeguarding certification (updated every 2yrs).
Kindergarten Teachers / TAs	Monitor behavioral changes, maintain logs, and follow intimate care rules.	Basic safeguarding & signs of abuse (updated annually).
Support Staff (Drivers / Kitchen)	Report environmental hazards or unusual adult-child interactions.	Safeguard